

phic design is the engagement factor. It is rumored that leather stitching used on iCal is based on the chairs on Steve Job's private jet. Interacting with these textures via a smart-phone engages the user. It reminds them of the real life experience of touching and leather and makes the process more natural.

More recently, with the rise of flat design, skeuomorphism has come under heavy scrutiny and a fair amount of criticism. One of the most common complaints against this philosophy is that it suppresses

innovation. The argument is that the philosophy as a whole concentrates too heavily on the aesthetics of the product and not the functionality. For example, the calculator application on the iOS has buttons which can be touched, so finding the sum of $2+3$ on the application takes more time than say, keying in $2+3$ on your keyboard on Google. While the aesthetics of a product are very important in a GUI, we must not forget the primary purpose of a computer is to carry out a task efficiently, and if the aesthetics gets in the way of this, it is bad engineering. Another common criticism is that skeuomorphic designs, no matter how authentic they look, cannot truly mimic the behavior of its real world analogue. This is essentially misleading behaviour. No matter how exquisite the graphic design is on your virtual leather, at the end of the day, you are swiping across glass, and this will never feel natural to you, so why try to mimic leather in the first place? Perhaps the most valid criticism of skeuomorphism is its lack of universality. It is not feasible to follow the skeuomorphic design style in all products. For products and services that were born in the realm of the internet (like e-commerce sites and search engines), there is no real world analogue whose behaviour is similar enough to imitate.



Familiarity breeds friendliness.